

Oceans and Continents

Oceans and Continents

- About **three-fourths** of the Earth's surface is covered with water.
 - The Earth is called the “**Blue Planet**” because most of it appears blue from space.
 - Large water bodies are called **oceans**.
 - Large land areas are called **continents or landmasses**.
-

Distribution of Water and Land

- Water and land are not equally distributed on Earth.
- The Southern Hemisphere has **more water. 80% water 20% Land**
- The Northern Hemisphere has **more land. 60% water 40% Land**
- **ALL Oceans are connected** to each other.

Freshwater

- Most water on Earth is salty seawater.
- Freshwater is found in:
 - Rivers
 - Lakes
 - Glaciers
 - Groundwater
 - Atmosphere

Water Scarcity

- Even with abundant water, usable freshwater is limited.
 - Water should be saved through:
 - **Rainwater harvesting**
 - **Reducing wastage**
 - **Reusing water**
-

The Five Oceans

- 1. Pacific Ocean – Largest ocean**
- 2. Atlantic Ocean**
- 3. Indian Ocean**
- 4. Southern (Antarctic) Ocean**
- 5. Arctic Ocean – Smallest ocean**

Indian Ocean

- **Bounded by:**
 - **Asia (north)**
 - **Africa (west)**
 - **Australia (east)**
 - **Two important parts near India:**
 - **Arabian Sea (west)**
 - **Bay of Bengal (east)**
-

4. Marine Life

- **Oceans contain rich marine flora and fauna.**
- **Marine plants include:**
 - **Algae**
 - **Seaweeds**
- **Marine animals include:**
 - **Fish**
 - **Dolphins**
 - **Whales**
 - **Sharks**

Importance of Oceans

- **Oceans help in:**
 - **Rainfall and monsoons**
 - **Climate regulation**
 - **Producing oxygen**
 - **Trade and transport**
 - **Fishing and food supply**
-

5. Oceans and Natural Disasters

Cyclones

- **Powerful storms formed over oceans.**
- **Cause heavy rainfall and strong winds.**

Tsunami

- **Huge sea wave caused by:**
 - **Underwater earthquakes**
 - **Volcanic eruptions**
- **Can destroy coastal regions.**

2004 Indian Ocean Tsunami

- **Occurred on 26 December 2004.**
- **Affected India and many other countries.**
- **Andaman & Nicobar Islands, Tamil Nadu, and Kerala suffered heavily.**

Disaster Management

- **India has the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA).**
 - **Countries work together in tsunami warning systems.**
-

Continents

The commonly accepted number of continents is seven:

1. Asia
2. Africa
3. North America
4. South America
5. Antarctica
6. Europe
7. Australia

Largest and Smallest Continents

- Largest: Asia
- Smallest: Australia

Eurasia

- Europe and Asia together are sometimes called Eurasia.
-

7. Islands

- A landmass surrounded by water on all sides is called an island.

Important Facts

- Greenland is the largest island in the world.
- India has more than 1,300 islands.

Major Indian Island Groups

1. Andaman and Nicobar Islands – Bay of Bengal
 2. Lakshadweep Islands – Arabian Sea
-

Antarctica and India

- Antarctica is the coldest continent.
 - India started the Indian Antarctica Programme in 1981.
 - India established research stations like Dakshin Gangotri.
-

Oceans and Human Life

- **Oceans are called the “lungs of the planet” because they produce more than half of Earth’s oxygen.**
- **Oceans support:**
 - **Trade**
 - **Migration**
 - **Culture**
 - **Food**

Threats to Oceans

- **Plastic pollution**
- **Overfishing**
- **Marine pollution**

Protection

- **Oceans must be protected for the future of Earth and humanity.**
-

Key Terms

- **Ocean: Large body of salt water.**
- **Continent: Large continuous landmass.**
- **Island: Land surrounded by water.**
- **Marine: Related to oceans and seas.**
- **Flora: Plant life.**
- **Fauna: Animal life.**